

1910 ▶ 1915

1910

Mapping the brain

German neuroscientist Korbinian Brodmann mapped the outer surface of the brain, called the cerebral cortex. He detailed how different parts of the cortex are responsible for different tasks, such as the primary visual cortex, which analyzes signals sent from the eyes.

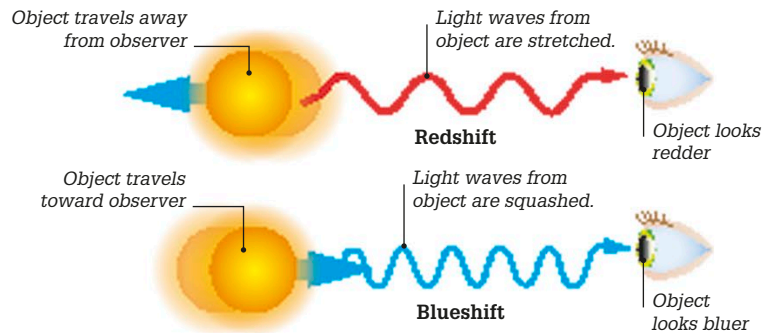
1910

Halley's Comet photographed

Observed as early as 1066, Halley's Comet was photographed for the first time in 1910. This 9-mile- (15-km-) long, 5-mile- (8-km) wide comet raced past Earth at a speed of more than 157,828 mph (254,000 kph).



Halley's comet streaks across the night sky, 1910



1912

Redshift and blueshift

American astronomer Vesto Slipher discovered that the Andromeda galaxy was moving toward us by detecting a change to the light reaching Earth from the approaching galaxy, called a blueshift. A redshift occurs when a body in space moves away from the observer.

1912

Pitdown man

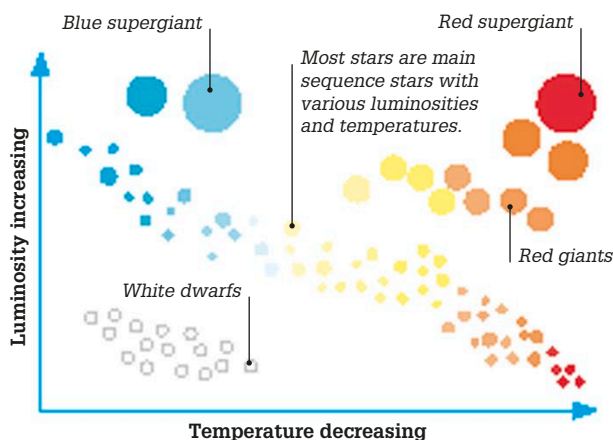
The remains of a man and primitive tools were discovered in Pitdown, England. The finds caused much interest as a missing link between apes and early humans, but were proven to be a hoax 41 years later.



1910

Classifying the stars

Danish astronomer Ejnar Hertzsprung and American astronomer Henry Russell devised a star chart that was later named the Hertzsprung-Russell (H-R) diagram. It shows the relationships between a star's temperature and color and its luminosity (the amount of energy given off by the star). This useful tool helped astronomers to group stars of similar types together.



1911

1911

Superconductors

Dutch physicist Heike Kamerlingh Onnes discovered how some metals at ultra-low temperatures conduct electricity with no resistance. These metals, known as superconductors, can carry an electric current without losing any energy and have applications in creating extremely powerful electromagnets and fast electronic circuits.

A member of the Amundsen team with their sled dogs at the South Pole.

Amundsen expedition

Norwegian explorer Roald Amundsen led the first successful expedition to the South Pole, reaching it on December 14, 1911. Along their two-month journey, the five-man expedition discovered the Axel Heiberg Glacier.

